

PERIOD OF BATTLE



WWI and beyond
1914–



Modern revolutionary
1780–1914



Early modern
1500–1780



Medieval
500–1500



Ancient
Before 500 CE

Yorktown, 1781

French-American victory over the British led to independence for the US.

Waterloo, 1815

Napoleon defeated by a coalition of European nations, marking an end to his domination of Europe.

Vienna, 1683

Holy Roman Empire's defeat of the Ottoman Empire halted the spread of Islam in Europe.

Spanish Armada, 1588

English defeat of a vast Spanish fleet, causing the loss of 63 ships.

Battle of France, 1940

German invasion and occupation of France during World War II.

Algiers, 1957

Campaign of guerrilla warfare against French-Algerian authorities.

Alcazar Quivir, 1578

Morocco and Ottoman Empire defeated the Portuguese Empire. Almost all Portuguese killed or imprisoned.

Kirina, 1235

Mandinka forces beat the Sosso king and created the Mali Empire over west Africa.

Riachuelo, Paraguay River, 1865

A naval battle far upriver. Defeat for Paraguay by Brazil (allied with Argentina and Uruguay) during the ruinous Paraguayan War (1864–70).

Bay of Pigs, 1961

CIA-trained force of Cuban exiles tried to invade Cuba and overthrow Communist leader Fidel Castro.

Carabobo, 1821

Victory for Simón Bolívar's Patriots over the Royalists, who supported Spanish rule. Led to Venezuela's independence.

Cajamarca, 1532

Defeat of the Inca Empire by Spanish conquistadors led to Spanish rule for the next three centuries.

Gettysburg, 1863

Turning point of the US Civil War. Paved the way for a Union victory over the Confederate states.

Antietam, 1862

Bloodiest single-day battle in American history, with 23,000 casualties.

The Little Bighorn, 1876

Victory for the Lakota, Northern Cheyenne, and Arapaho peoples over the US Army led by General Custer.

The Alamo, 1836

Texan revolutionaries inflicted heavy losses on Mexican forces storming the Alamo Fort. Mexico won, but Texas gained independence the next year.

Military milestones

Changes in weapon technology have affected how battles are fought. As weapons get deadlier, the two sides in a battle grow farther and farther apart, until today, they sometimes don't meet or glimpse each other at all.

1 Battle of Crécy, 1346
A key battle in the Hundred Years' War between England and France. New long-range bows made close hand-to-hand combat, and the chivalry that went with it, a thing of the past.

2 The Somme, 1916
The British and French attacked the German Army during World War I in what was the world's first use of tanks in battle. It was also one of the bloodiest military operations ever.

3 Battle of Britain, 1940
Between Britain and Germany during World War II, this was the first major campaign fought entirely in the air.

4 Battle of the Coral Sea, 1942
For the first time, ships in this sea battle never once sighted or directly fired on one another.

**THE OTTOMAN TURKS TOOK
CONSTANTINOPLE IN 1453 USING
CANNONS FOR THE FIRST TIME
IN A MAJOR BATTLE**